

# Polite Requests: Can or Could?

## Requests

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Choose the more polite request.

- 1 Which is the most polite?  
**a) Give me the menu.   b) Could I see the menu, please?   c) I want the menu.**
  - 2 Which is the most polite?  
**a) Could you tell me the time, please?   b) Tell me the time.   c) Time?**
  - 3 Which is the most polite?  
**a) Open the door.   b) Door open!   c) Could you open the door, please?**
  - 4 Which is correct?  
**a) Can you passing the salt?   b) Can you pass the salt?   c) Can you passes the salt?**
  - 5 Which is correct?  
**a) Could I to have some water?   b) Could I have some water?   c) Could I having some water?**
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- 1 Can you \_\_\_\_\_ (open) the door, please?
  - 2 Could I \_\_\_\_\_ (have) some water?

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### Choose

1. Could I see the menu, please?
2. Could you tell me the time, please?
3. Could you open the door, please?
4. Can you pass the salt?
5. Could I have some water?

### Fill in

1. open
2. have

### Teacher's notes

Both forms are fine; could is more formal.